

them, as I did. It wasn't a very nice feeling, and it added to the guilt that I already felt about the financial difficulty my family was in – how awful must I be as a person, if I couldn't even feel properly happy for my friends?

It's important to remember that feeling envious every now and again is completely normal, and as long as the green-eyed monster is a transient beast and doesn't linger for too long, it's unlikely that there will be any lasting effect on your relationships or sense of self-worth. But if envy and resentment are left to linger, or allowed to remain unchallenged, they can leave a serious dent in your happiness and hamper your ability to appreciate any of the good things in your own life. What's more, when we consider hedonic adaption, it becomes clear that even if we were to gain the thing that we've been coveting – the thing that *that* person has, that we don't – it would be unlikely to have a lasting effect on our happiness anyway. This applies to any type of envy – professional, personal, or financial.

I'd like to give you the opportunity here to work through any feelings of envy that you're harbouring at the moment. Consider who they are directed at, how strong they are and how long you've been holding on to them. Now, ask yourself how you would feel if you gained that coveted thing, whether it's a job, a possession, a certain amount of money. Have you been pinning all of your imaginings of happiness and fulfilment on this one thing? Do you think that's a realistic view of things? Think about how that jealousy is affecting your happiness at